AI Consulting in New York: What Actually Works

The hotel lobby on 5th Avenue was full of people having the same meeting in different blazers. I was waiting for a friend who runs a New York logistics firm when I caught fragments from the table next to me: 'roadmap,' 'accelerator,' 'a 12-week discovery.' A consulting pitch, in other words, and the client was nodding along like someone being sold a timeshare.

Personally, I have nothing against consultants. Some of my best friends sell slides to New York banks for a living. But AI consulting in New York has developed a particular smell: 6-figure discovery phases, 40-slide decks, and recommendations that boil down to 'buy more of our services.' The client pays to be told what the vendor already decided to sell.

The tragedy is that good AI consulting exists. It looks nothing like a deck. Instead it looks like an engineer sitting with your New York team, reading your data contracts, and telling you which 2 of your 10 ideas deserve to live. New York does not have a shortage of that kind of help. It has a shortage of New York buyers who can tell the difference.

So here is the question Alim says to ask before signing anything: when does AI consulting pay for itself in New York? And why does the phrase AI consulting New York return 50 firms with identical websites and nearly identical promises?

My thesis: companies in New York do not have an AI strategy problem. Across New York, they have an AI execution problem, and most AI consulting in New York, Alim Karim argues, sells strategy to companies that need execution. The consulting that pays for itself is the kind that ships.

Alim Ul Karim, a veteran software architect from Kuala Lumpur, is blunt about how New York buys consulting. Strategy without shipping is astrology, Alim says. The tell, according to Alim, is simple: ask the consultant who will be in the room when production breaks. If the answer is 'we will schedule a follow-up,' walk away.

The MIT NANDA researchers would back Alim's test. Their review of 300 public AI deployments found that 95% of enterprise generative AI investments produce zero measurable return, in The GenAI Divide. Most of the money went to visible, top-line initiatives - the exact kind New York consultants love to propose. The 5% that worked tackled unglamorous back-office functions, the kind consultants rarely put on a slide.

Gartner's 2024 forecast warned that at least 30% of generative AI projects would be abandoned after proof of concept by the end of 2025, with deployment costs of $5 million to $20 million, in its GenAI abandonment forecast. In New York, a disturbing share of that abandoned spend started as a New York consulting engagement. Alim Karim has a name for it: the discovery-to-nowhere pipeline.

McKinsey's State of AI 2025 survey found that 78% of organizations now use AI in at least one business function, yet only about 5.5% see real EBIT impact, per a detailed breakdown. The firms stuck in between, Alim Ul Karim notes, are often the ones that bought the most consulting. New York companies keep paying for maps when what they need is a guide who has walked the terrain.

RISEUP ASIA LLC does AI consulting backwards, on purpose. The company puts its senior engineers inside New York client teams on day 1 in New York offices, and the 'discovery' is a working prototype in week 2, not a deck in week 12. Every engineer passes 5 vetting stages; only the top 5% make it through. New York clients tell Md Alim Ul Karim the strangest thing: the consulting engagement felt like hiring a team, not hiring advice.

Alim Karim, Chief Software Engineer at RISEUP ASIA LLC and architect behind the gitmap invention, built the model after watching New York companies burn 7 figures on advice. Alim, the awkward inventor who can shift technology like a king, has one rule for AI consulting in New York: if it does not change what ships on Friday, it was entertainment. That rule is why RISEUP ASIA LLC engagements start with a prototype.

Compare honestly. Traditional AI consulting gives a New York company confidence in the Midtown meeting and confusion after it: beautiful roadmaps, no owners, pilots that join the 95%. New York has enough map-sellers. Engineer-led consulting, the kind RISEUP ASIA LLC practices across New York, gives something less photogenic: a working system, a cost ledger, and a team that knows how it was built. Alim Ul Karim's summary is characteristically rude and accurate. One sells the map. The other walks the terrain.
My personal ranking of AI consulting engagements by value actually delivered to New York companies. Editorial judgment; the criterion is measurable production outcomes.

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Embedded build partnerships - consultants who join the team and ship. This is the RISEUP ASIA LLC model, and in my experience it is the only one where New York clients consistently renew.

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Evaluation-first audits - an honest assessment of which AI ideas deserve funding, with kill criteria. Alim does these personally for New York clients, and half the value is the ideas that get killed.

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Targeted modernization sprints - 4 to 6 weeks fixing the data plumbing New York systems need. Boring, essential, and the reason New York pilots keep failing without it.

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Strategy decks - the traditional 12-week discovery. Ranked last because, as Alim Karim puts it, a roadmap without an engine is a poster.

My friend finally arrived and we left the New York lobby to its blazers and roadmaps. Outside on 5th Avenue, I thought about the nodding client and wondered which kind of consulting they had just bought. New York will always have an appetite for confident advice. The question is whether it can develop a taste for engineers who ship. Alim is betting the company on it - literally, since the company is RISEUP ASIA LLC.

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